concepti fetus reddunt examina, sicut exemplo mirabili Christus ore paterno processit. Fecunda est in his sine partu virginitas, quam utique Dominus sequi [33] dignatus carnalem se matrem habere virginitatis amore constituit. Talia igitur, Domine, digne [34] sacris altaribus tuis munera offeruntur, quibus te laetari religio Christiana non ambigit.

Benedictio super incensum [35].

Veniat ergo, omnipotens Deus, super hunc incensum larga tuae benedictionis infusio, et hunc nocturnum splendorem, invisibilis regnator, intende; ut non solum sacrificium quod hac nocte litatum est arcana luminis tui admixtione refulgeat, sed quocumque loco ex huius aliquid sanctificationis fuerit mysterio deportatum, expulsa diabolica fraudis nequitia, virtus tuae maiestatis [36] assistat. Per Dominum nostrum Iesum Christum Filium tuum, qui tecum vivit et regnat Deus in unitate Spiritus sancti per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen. γ Mur. ii. 146.

Post hoc surgens sacerdos a sede sua, dicit orationes de vigilia Paschae, sicut in Sacramentorum [37] *continetur.*

[1] S. has not any form for the *Redditio Symboli*: but it has a trace of the ceremony in the rubric *Sabbato sancto postquam reddunt symbolum et catechizantur infantes impletur cerei benedictio.* R. contains the form as part of the *Ordo Baptisterii* (see Gerb. p. 252), but unfortunately some liquid has been spilt on this part of the MS., which has rendered the rubrics almost entirely illegible, except that at the beginning of the section, which is not correctly reproduced by Gerb. It runs *Sabbatorum diae mane reddentes symbolū prius cathacizas eos Inposita super caput eorum manu his verbis.* The form given by Martène (*de Ant. Eccl. Rit.* lib. I. cap. i.) from the Codex Gellonensis is in pretty close agreement with V. and R. Its readings are occasionally noted below (cited as Gell.). [2] R. inserts *quicumque es spiritus immunde.* [3] Gerb. inserts *Spiritus sancti*, but the words are not in R. [4] *remissione* R. [5] This rubric is illegible in R.; Gell. has *Deinde tangit eos presbyter per singulos nares et aures de sputo oris sui dicens* [? *ad*] *unumquemque aurem.* [6] *Effecta* V.; Gell. has *Effeta* twice; R. as text. [7] This rubric also is illegible in R.: in Gell. the unction and interrogatories are concurrent. After the conclusion of the latter R. inserts '*Dicit presbyter* Ego te linio de oleo salutis in Christo Iesu Domino nostro in vitam aeternam. Amen.' After the recitation of the Creed R. inserts interrogations as to the belief of the catechumens similar to those in the Baptismal Order of V. (xliv *inf.*) and after the response to the last of these proceeds, '*Complete orationem vestram*,' &c. [8] *foris* V. [9] *locis vestris* R.; V. Gell. as text (all ungrammatically). [10] *et expectantes* V. R.; Gell. as text: but perhaps *expectantes = expectantes estote.* [11] The rubrics of this *Ordo* are not in R. S. or Gerb., which give the more ordinary form for the *Benedictio cerei.* The form given in V. has been compared with the text given by Gerbert, vol. ii. p. 205, from a twelfth cent. Vienna MS. (cited as Gerb.) and with that given in Muratori's Gregorian Sacramentary (*Lit. Rom. Vet.* ii. 145). The latter is cited as Mur. [12] So V. (ungrammatically). [13] Gerb. omits *cereum.* [14] *nec* Mur.; V. Gerb. as text. [15] *sed cera atque stuppa* Gerb. [16] *constrictum* V. [17] *honorem* Mur. [18] *cumulare* Mur. [19] *in fonte veri fulgoris et lumine* Gerb.; V. Mur. as text. [20] *at* Mur. [21] *primo plaustro* V.; *protoplasto* Gerb.; Mur. as text. [22] *servitutem* Gerb. (and so

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Tommasi): V. Mur. as text, not necessarily ungrammatically. [23] *liberatis* V.; Mur. Gerb. as text. [24] *placida* V. Mur.; Gerb. as text. [25] *extolluntur* V. [26] *per quem* V. [27] *et* Gerb. [28] *huius gratia luminis* Gerb. [29] *deluantur* V. [30] *caere* V.; Mur. Gerb. as text. [31] *fundatus quarum* V.; *fundatas; quarum . . . coaequat* Mur.; *fundatas, quibus . . . coaequatur* Gerb.; Tommasi reads *fundatas, quas . . . coaequat*: but it seems just possible that *fundatas* may be a substantival form. [32] Gerb. omits *in*. [33] Mur. omits *sequi*. [34] *dignae* V.; *digna* Mur. Gerb. [35] Gerb. does not contain this Benediction. [36] *virtutis tuae majestas* Mur. [37] Probably the word *libro* should be inserted. This reference to a *liber Sacramentorum* suggests that the form has been copied in V. from a MS. of another kind, to which this name would not apply, the final rubric having been copied as well as the rest, without regard to the fact that the prayers in question follow immediately in V.

XLIII.

ORATIONES PER SINGULAS LECTIONES IN SABBATO SANCTO[1]. 566

R. S. (1) Gerb. 83. Mur. ii. 147.

Deus, qui divitias misericordiae tuae in hac praecipue nocte largiris, propitiare universo ordini sacerdotalis officii, et omnes gradus famulatus nostri perfecta delictorum remissione sanctifica, ut ministraturos regeneratrici[2] gratiae tuae nulli esse obnoxios patiaris offensae[3]. Per. γ

Sequitur lectio: In principio fecit Deus.

R. S. (3) Gerb. 83. Mur. ii. 147.

Deus, incommutabilis virtus, lumen aeternum, respice propitius ad totius[4] ecclesiae tuae mirabile sacramentum, et opus salutis humanae perpetuae dispositionis affectu tranquillus[5] operare, totusque mundus experiatur et videat deiecta erigi, inveterata novari, et per ipsum redire omnia in integrum, a quo sumpsere principium. Per. γ

Sequitur de Noe.

R. S. (10) Gerb. 84. Mur. ii. 149.

Omnipotens sempiterne Deus, qui in omnium operum tuorum dispensatione mirabilis es, intelligant redempti tui non fuisse excellentius quod initio factus est mundus, quam quod in fine[6] saeculorum Pascha nostrum immolatus est Christus. Per eundem Dominum[7]. γ

De Abraham tertia.

R. S. (4) Gerb. 83. Mur. ii. 148.

Deus, fidelium Pater summe, qui in toto orbe terrarum promissionis tuae filios diffusa adoptione[8] multiplicas et per paschale sacramentum Abraham puerum tuum universarum, sicut iurasti, gentium efficis patrem, da populis tuis digne ad gratiam tuae vocationis intrare. Per. γ

In Exodo quarta, cum cantico Cantemus Domino.

R. S. (5) Cf. Gerb. 83.

Deus[9], cuius antiqua miracula etiam nostris saeculis coruscare sentimus, dum quod uni populo a persecutione

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